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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 2

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Reserva de una instalación deportiva

Receptionist: Good morning, Riverside Sports Centre. How can I help?

Customer: Hello, I'd like to book one of your tennis courts for this weekend, please.

Receptionist: Certainly. Can I take your name?

Customer: Yes, it's Daniel Harris.

Receptionist: Before we go through the individual choices, I should explain how I handle a sports-facility booking. I will confirm your priorities first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Customer: That approach is exactly what I need for the sports-facility booking. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Receptionist: And a contact number?

Customer: My mobile is 078 5501 3742.

Receptionist: Thank you. What day were you thinking?

Customer: Saturday, if possible. In the afternoon.

Customer: For this sports-facility booking, I am more concerned about reliability than an impressive description. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Receptionist: Of course. In this sports-facility booking, I will make each trade-off explicit as we proceed, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Receptionist: Let me check. We have Court 3 free from two o'clock to four o'clock.

Customer: That would be perfect. We're a group of four players.

Receptionist: Great. The cost for that slot is twelve pounds per hour, so that's twenty-four pounds in total.

Customer: I see. Do you offer any kind of membership discount?

Receptionist: A sports-facility booking can involve names, dates and choices that sound alike when they are given quickly. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Customer: I will. For the sports-facility booking, it is useful to know which details are certain, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Receptionist: Yes, members receive a twenty percent discount, bringing it to just over nineteen pounds.

Customer: I'm not a member yet. Is it easy to join?

Receptionist: Very straightforward. You fill in a form online or in person. Annual membership is sixty-five pounds and includes unlimited use of the gym and swimming pool, as well as discounted court hire.

Customer: That sounds good. Can I also book a coach for a session?

Receptionist: Let me finish the sports-facility booking by summarising what I have recorded. For this sports-facility booking, I will read back the information in order, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the sports-facility booking, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Customer: Good. During the sports-facility booking, I will listen carefully and check it against the notes I brought.

Customer: Do you have racket hire?

Receptionist: We do - two pounds fifty per racket per session. You can collect them from the equipment room near the main entrance.

Receptionist: Absolutely. Our head coach, Mr Patel, is available on Saturday from ten to twelve in the morning.

Customer: I'd prefer the afternoon, to match our court booking.

Customer: Before we close the sports-facility booking, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Receptionist: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Receptionist: In that case, our other coach, Ms Carter, is available from half past two.

Customer: Brilliant. We'll take that.

Receptionist: Shall I put you down for thirty minutes or a full hour?

Customer: A full hour, please.

Receptionist: Before I close this sports-facility booking, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Customer: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Receptionist: Just so it is clear, no, coaching is not included with membership; it is charged separately.

Receptionist: Done. Is there anything else you need?

Customer: Perfect. Thank you very much.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Charla de orientación del campus

Welcome, everyone, to Greenfield University. I'm James, one of the student advisors, and I'll be giving you a quick overview of the campus and the services available to you. Let's start with the library. The main library is open seven days a week - from eight in the morning until ten at night on weekdays, and nine to six on weekends. You'll need your student card to access the building after six in the evening. The library holds over 400,000 physical books and gives you access to more than 200 academic databases online. If a book you need isn't available here, you can request an inter-library loan, which usually takes three to five working days. Before describing the individual features of this campus orientation talk, it is useful to understand the overall sequence.

The information for the campus orientation talk follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, beginning with orientation and moving towards more specialised areas. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the campus orientation talk easier to follow. Next, the Student Support Centre. This is located in the Fleming Building, just to the left of the main gate as you come in. It handles a wide range of services - academic advice, welfare support, and financial guidance. They also run a peer mentoring programme where second and third-year students are paired with first-years to help with the transition to university life. Some arrangements connected with the campus orientation talk may operate differently during the present programme.

During the campus orientation talk, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time. Where a condition in the campus orientation talk is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. The health centre is on the south side of the campus, next to the sports hall. You should register as soon as possible - appointments can be booked online or by phone. There is a pharmacist on site on Tuesdays and Thursdays. As the campus orientation talk continues, a shorter route may reach the same principal areas. Within the campus orientation talk, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme.

If an alternative becomes necessary during the campus orientation talk, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Regarding accommodation: if you're in university halls, your warden is your first point of contact for any issues. Each hall also has a common room that stays open until midnight. Do not try to memorise every detail of the campus orientation talk at once. The most important instructions will return when they become relevant. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. Finally, transport. The university operates a free shuttle bus between the north campus, the main campus, and the train station.

It runs every fifteen minutes from seven in the morning until eleven at night. You don't need to book - just turn up and show your student card. A final way to follow the campus orientation talk is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. Descriptions help you build a mental map, whereas instructions tell you when to move or decide. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme.

Please feel free to ask questions at the end - we want to make sure your first weeks here go smoothly. If you become uncertain during the campus orientation talk, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking.

Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Conversación sobre un proyecto de energía renovable

Sarah: Hi Tom. Have you had a chance to look at the feedback from Professor Jenkins on our renewable energy project?

Tom: Yes - overall I thought it was quite positive. She liked the section on solar power, but said we need to develop our argument about wind energy more.

Sarah: I agree. I think we relied too much on statistics and not enough on case studies. Real-world examples would make it more convincing.

Sarah: Before we settle on an interpretation for the renewable-energy project, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Tom: Agreed. For the renewable-energy project, we can state the initial expectation and then test it against each observation. That will make the argument more credible.

Tom: That's a good point. I found a report from the Danish government on their offshore wind programme - apparently they now get over 50% of their electricity from wind. That's a compelling example.

Sarah: Perfect. Should we add a new section or revise what we already have?

Tom: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the renewable-energy project. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Sarah: Yes. The audience needs to know what the design can and cannot establish.

Tom: I think revise. Adding a new section might make the report too long. Professor Jenkins also commented that our introduction was too vague.

Sarah: Right, she wants a clearer thesis statement from the start.

Sarah: Another question is whether our categories for the renewable-energy project are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Tom: For the renewable-energy project, let us define the variable before presenting the measurement. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Tom: Exactly. Now, what about the conclusion? I felt it was quite weak.

Sarah: Yes, we basically just summarised what we'd said. We need to make some stronger recommendations.

Tom: The order of the renewable-energy project presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Sarah: For the renewable-energy project, we can add a linking sentence at each handover and rehearse the transitions.

Tom: Like what?

Sarah: Well, we could recommend that governments set mandatory renewable energy targets - say, sixty percent renewables by 2035.

Sarah: Our final review of the renewable-energy project should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Tom: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can record the remaining action beside the person responsible for it.

Tom: Good idea. We could also suggest increased investment in grid infrastructure, since that's often the bottleneck.

Sarah: Agreed. One thing I wanted to ask you about is the map we were asked to include showing wind farm locations. Did you manage to create it?

Tom: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the renewable-energy project, including the reason for it.

Sarah: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Tom: I started it but I'm having trouble with the software. The labels aren't positioning correctly.

Sarah: I can help with that. I used the same programme for my geography project.

Sarah: Before we finish the renewable-energy project, let us read the argument from the perspective of somebody who did not collect the evidence. Each claim should identify what was observed, how it was measured and which limitation affects the interpretation.

Tom: I will also check that our recommendation follows from the result rather than from what we expected at the beginning. If a sentence sounds stronger than the method allows, we can narrow it without losing the main point.

Sarah: Good. Then the final version will show a clear line from the research question through the evidence to the conclusion.

Tom: That would be great. Can we meet Thursday to work on it together?

Sarah: Sure. Let's meet at the library at two o'clock.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Conferencia sobre ecosistemas de arrecifes de coral

Today I want to discuss one of the planet's most diverse and threatened ecosystems: coral reefs. To place the coral-reef ecosystems lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the coral-reef ecosystems lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through repeated experiments, local adaptations and occasional failures. A simple list of events in the coral-reef ecosystems lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. Coral reefs cover less than one percent of the ocean floor, yet they support approximately 25% of all known marine species. This extraordinary concentration of biodiversity makes them one of the most ecologically important environments on Earth.

Evidence for the coral-reef ecosystems lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare individual cases with broader samples collected over time. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. Corals are animals, not plants - a common misconception. Each individual coral is called a polyp. Polyps secrete a hard calcium carbonate skeleton, and over thousands of years these skeletons accumulate to form the reef structure. Inside each polyp live tiny algae called zooxanthellae.

This is a symbiotic relationship: the algae photosynthesise, providing the coral with up to 90% of its energy, while the coral provides the algae with nutrients and shelter. Scale is especially important when evaluating the coral-reef ecosystems lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this coral-reef ecosystems lecture, no striking individual example should be treated as a universal rule. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. When water temperatures rise even slightly above normal - sometimes by just one degree Celsius - the coral expels the zooxanthellae. This is known as coral bleaching.

Without the algae, the coral turns white and, if temperatures remain high, the coral eventually dies. Mass bleaching events have become far more frequent due to climate change. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the coral-reef ecosystems lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. A conclusion should be as strong as the evidence allows, but no stronger. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together.

Other major threats include ocean acidification, which reduces the availability of calcium carbonate and weakens reef structures; physical damage from boat anchors, tourist divers, and destructive fishing practices such as blast fishing; and the spread of invasive species such as the crown-of-thorns starfish, which feeds on coral tissue. The separate examples in the coral-reef ecosystems lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the coral-reef

ecosystems lecture, returning to those questions will connect evidence gathered at different scales. The conclusion to the coral-reef ecosystems lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence.

Conservation efforts are varied. Marine protected areas restrict human activities in key reef zones. Coral gardening programmes grow coral fragments in underwater nurseries and then transplant them onto damaged reefs. Scientists are also developing heat-resistant strains of coral through selective breeding. A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the coral-reef ecosystems lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together.

The challenge is significant, but many conservationists argue that with immediate action on carbon emissions and local pollution, the worst outcomes can still be avoided. One final point about the coral-reef ecosystems lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation. A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation. Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains.

Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.